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| 1960 | The AFPFL faction led by U Nu wins parliamentary elections. |
| 1961 | U Thant becomes the third United Nations Secretary-General. |
| 1962 | A military coup d'état led by General Ne Win removes U Nu from power. He then implements the “Burmese Way to Socialism”—nationalizing the economy, forming a single-party state, and banning independent newspapers. |
| 1974 | A new constitution transfers power from the armed forces to a people's assembly headed by the military. |
| | U Thant's body is returned to Burma for burial. |
| 1975 | Minority groups form the National Democratic Front. |
| 1981 | Ne Win gives up the presidency to General San Yu but continues in his role as the chairman of the ruling Socialist Programme Party. |
| 1982 | The Burmese citizenship law is passes. The law designates people who are considered nonindigenous as “associate citizens” and denies them rights offered to full citizens. |
| 1983 | North Korean agents try to assassinate South Korean President Chun Doo Hwan during his state visit to Burma. The bomb kills 21 South Korean government officials and four Burmese dignitaries as well as wounding 42 but Chun Doo Hwan escaped unharmed. |
| 1987 | A currency devaluation triggers massive antigovernment riots. |
| 1988 | The border between Burma and China is officially opened. |
| | Thousands of demonstrators are killed in antigovernment riots. The State Law and Order Restoration Council (SLORC) is formed. |
| | Aung San Suu Kyi cofounds the National League for Democracy (NLD). |
| 1989 | SLORC declares martial law, arrests thousands of opposition supporters, and renames Burma as Myanmar. The name of the capital Rangoon is changed to Yangon. |
| 1990 | The NLD easily win the elections allowed by the government, but the SLORC invalidates the result. |
| 1991 | SLORC decides to extend Aung San Suu Kyi's house arrest by another three years. |
| | The Nobel Committee awards Aung San Suu Kyi the Nobel Peace Prize. |
| 1992 | General Than Shwe replaces General Saw Maung as SLORC chairman, prime minister, and defense minister. |
| | Several political prisoners are released in an effort to improve Myanmar's international image. |
| 1993 | The United States imposes an arms embargo on Myanmar. |